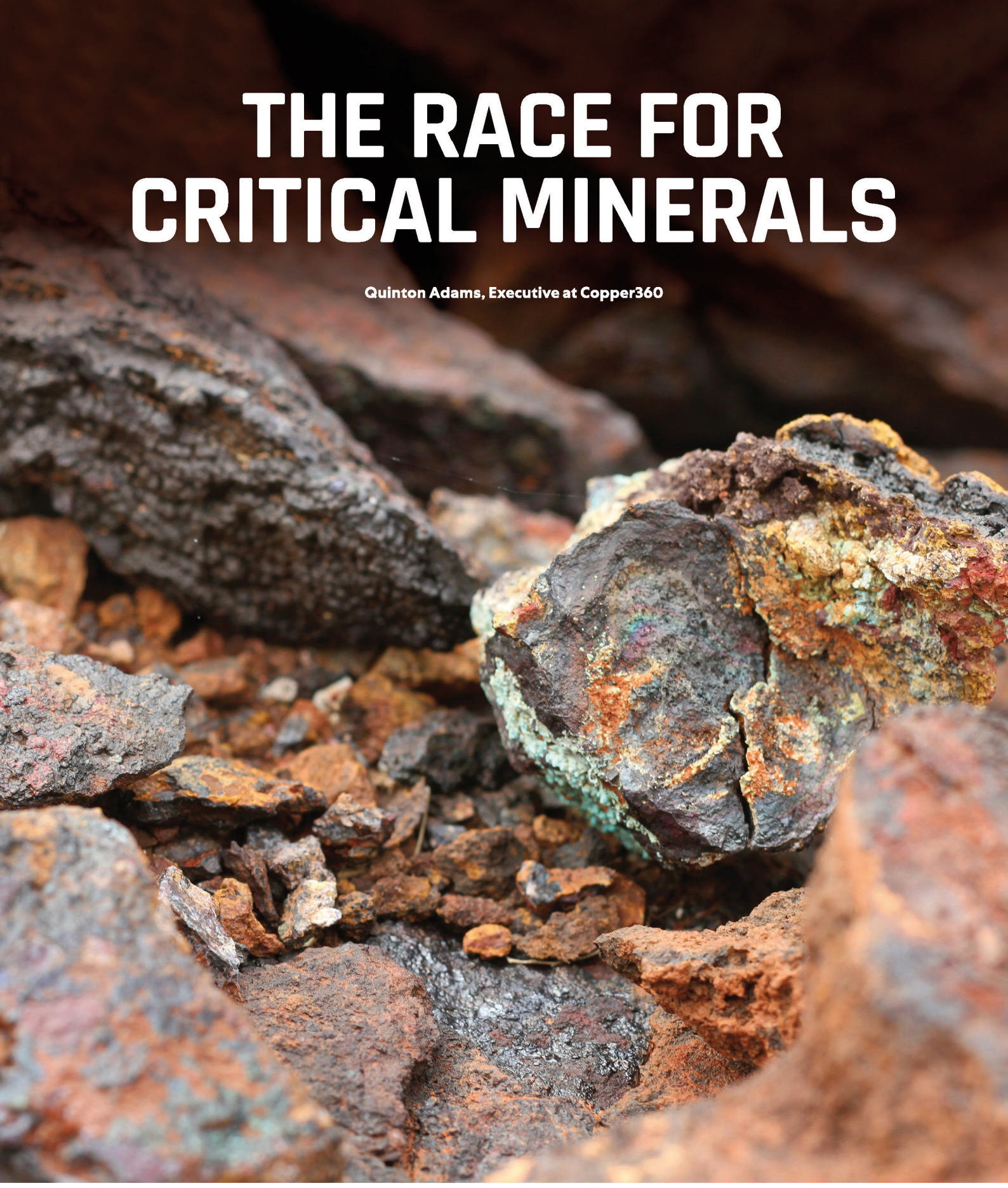
THE RACE FOR CRITICAL MINERALS

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Critical minerals have surged to the forefront of global politics and economics. As the world transitions to renewable energy and digital technologies, minerals such as lithium, cobalt, copper, nickel, and rare earth elements (REEs) have become the backbone of modern industry, powering electric vehicles, wind turbines, smartphones, and defence systems.

In his book *Africa: Crude Continent*, Duncan Clarke chronicled the early 2000s oil and gas scramble in Africa, where over 500 companies from six continents competed for fossil fuel resources. Two decades later, that competition has evolved. The new rush is not for barrels of oil, but for the minerals that will define the future of energy and technology.